

Rock bands

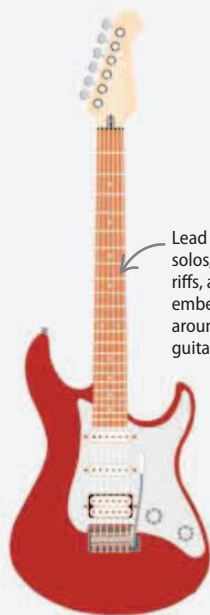
Rock bands are an iconic symbol of popular music in the 20th century. The combination of guitars, drums, keyboard, and vocals have made countless bands rich and famous, including the Beatles, Rolling Stones, Queen, and Led Zeppelin.

Set up

A rock band's setup varies according to the number of performers, the shape of the stage, and the size of the venue. The drummer, driving the rhythm, normally sits in the center at the back of the group. The bass guitarist stands to one side near the keyboard, with guitars and vocals in the front line. Microphones can be positioned in front of each performer, with amplifiers and speakers at the side.

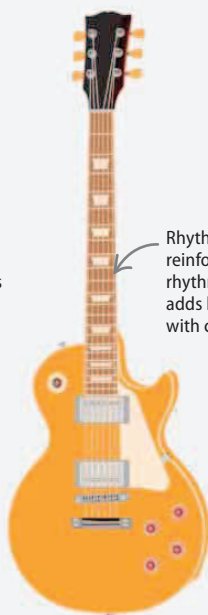
Guitars

There are usually three guitars in a rock band—lead, rhythm, and bass—each with a different function. Powerful electric guitars are normally used instead of the quieter acoustic type.



Lead guitar

Lead guitar plays solos, melodies, or riffs, and improvises embellishments around the rhythm guitar part.



Rhythm guitar

Rhythm guitar reinforces the music's rhythmic pulse and adds harmony with chords.

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The cymbal is struck by the drummer with a drumstick or brush.

Drums are the rhythmic heart of a rock band, maintaining a steady beat, adding syncopations (off-beats), and “swinging” the rhythm where necessary.

Drums

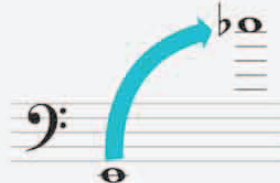
LOOKING CLOSER

Electric guitars

The slim, solid body of an electric guitar does not resonate, so the instrument's natural sound is quiet. Connecting it to an amplifier makes the sound powerful. The bass guitar sounds an octave lower than the lead and rhythm instruments.



Rhythm guitar range



Bass guitar range